

CONTEXT

A follow-up to our May 5th conversation

This document is a structured version of what we discussed — not a proposal, and not a pitch. You named speed as Cedar's primary constraint, and you were clear that client data cannot leave your network under any circumstances. Both of those shaped everything below.

You're already building with Claude. The goal here is to map the broader surface area of where a locally deployed agent system could operate across Cedar's practice — across tax, legal, and valuations — and to lay out the two most practical security architectures for a firm with your infrastructure profile.

Details about Cedar's team size, stack, and workflow patterns referenced below are drawn from a publicly available Missive case study (missiveapp.com/customers/cedar-consulting-group). Where those details have changed, the architectural suggestions remain valid — specific tool recommendations may vary.

WHERE AGENTS APPLY

Eight functions worth exploring

Every one of these compresses knowledge work — pushing tasks to 70-80% completion before a principal's attention is required.

01

Research Agent

First-pass research on CRA interpretation bulletins, ITA provisions, case law, and technical interpretations — surfaced before you open a document. Cedar regularly does original research on issues other accountants can't resolve. An agent that handles the first sweep compresses that from hours to minutes.

Tax

Legal

02

Step Plan & Memo Drafting

Reorganizations and M&A transactions require detailed step plans — precise sequences of legal and tax steps. An agent that takes the desired outcome and corporate structure as inputs and produces a first-draft step plan extends the proposal generator you've already built into the delivery phase.

Tax

Legal

03

Calculation Workflows

ACB tracking, paid-up capital computations, safe income determination, RDTOH, CDA balances, purchase price allocation — complex but rule-based. An agent that runs the calculation logic and produces a formatted report eliminates both manual calculation time and the review burden that follows it.

Tax

Valuations

04

Precedent & Institutional Memory

Cedar has years of accumulated work — prior structures, positions taken, memos written, issues resolved. A local agent that indexes Cedar's own work product and lets anyone on the team query it turns your firm's history into a searchable asset. Nothing leaves the network.

All Practice Areas

05

CRA Audit Response Drafting

Audit defense follows a consistent structure: facts, issue, CRA's position, taxpayer's position, argument, conclusion. An agent that takes the audit issue and client facts as inputs and produces a first-draft submission compresses what is often a full day of drafting into a review and refinement task.

Tax

06

Due Diligence Assistant

In M&A work Cedar reviews financial statements, corporate documents, and contracts to identify tax exposures and risks. An agent that processes a document package and produces a structured list of findings and red flags front-loads the analytical work before a principal's attention is required.

Tax

Legal

Valuations

07

Client Communication Drafting

Advisory work generates a significant volume of explanatory writing — letters translating complex restructuring rationale into plain language, summaries of audit outcomes, engagement updates. An agent trained on Cedar's prior communications could draft these to a high degree of completion in your voice and to your standard.

All Practice Areas

08

Advisor-to-Advisor Intake

When other accountants bring complex issues to Cedar, an agent that takes the presenting issue, runs preliminary research, and produces a structured brief means you walk into those consulting conversations already oriented — not starting from zero.

Tax

Legal

Two practical paths for Cedar

Based on Cedar's existing Microsoft infrastructure (Outlook, Office 365), these two paths represent the most practical fit. Alternative paths exist for Google-native environments.

PATH 01

Local Deployment

An open-source model runs entirely on Cedar's own hardware. No data leaves the building under any circumstances. Tools like Ollama make this accessible without significant infrastructure overhead.

Data security	Complete — nothing leaves the network
Capability	Good — lower than frontier models, workable for most functions above
Infrastructure	Capable workstation or dedicated on-premise server
Best for	Highest-sensitivity work; maximum control

PATH 02

Azure Private Endpoints

Frontier-level models run within Cedar's own Azure cloud tenant via private endpoints. Data never touches Microsoft's shared infrastructure. Cedar is already in the Microsoft ecosystem — this extends that environment rather than introducing a new one.

Data security	Strong — data stays within Cedar's Azure tenant
Capability	Full frontier model quality (GPT-4o class)
Infrastructure	Azure subscription; Microsoft contractual data residency
Best for	Maximum capability with enterprise-grade compliance

Note: These recommendations are based on Cedar's Microsoft stack as described in the Missive case study. If Cedar has since moved to or added Google Workspace, a Google Vertex AI deployment is an equally strong alternative and worth discussing.

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Questions or thoughts? Reach out directly — no scheduling required.

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